

DANIAL SALMAN

Owen Graduate School of Management, 401 21st Avenue South, Nashville, TN 37203

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ACADEMIC POSITION

Postdoctoral Scholar in Finance
Owen Graduate School of Management, Vanderbilt University

2026–present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Business Administration (Finance)
Foster School of Business, University of Washington

2026

B.A. and **M.A.** in Economics (Dual Degree Program)
Boston University

2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Household Finance, Labor and Finance, Innovation, and Venture Capital

WORKING PAPERS

End of the Road? Autonomous Vehicles and Displacement Risk [\[SSRN\]](#)

New technologies have renewed concerns about job displacement. In this paper, I link workers' subjective displacement expectations to their direct and social exposure to a disruptive technology: autonomous vehicles (AVs). I find that commercial driver licensing and employment in truck driving fall disproportionately in more AV-exposed areas. The remaining drivers extend their work hours and reduce participation in mortgage markets relative to less-exposed, neighboring drivers. Changes in household spending on alcohol and tobacco products are consistent with heightened automation-induced anxiety. The results indicate that perceived displacement risk affects households' labor supply, credit behavior, and health, all of which could inform welfare assessments and policy responses to automation.

**NBER SI 2026 Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence, NBER Economics of Transportation Spring 2026, Colorado Finance Summit 2025*

**Featured in the Financial Times*

Relief Beliefs: Effects of Anticipated Student Loan Forgiveness (with Xuan Xie) [\[SSRN\]](#)

Political support for student loan forgiveness has been growing, particularly on the left, but evidence regarding its effects remains limited. We evaluate the immediate consumption response to President Biden's 2022 loan forgiveness announcement which promised debt relief of \$10,000 to \$20,000 for approximately 42 million borrowers. We find that retail stores located in counties with a 1 percentage point higher share of eligible student loan borrowers saw a persistent 0.1% increase in weekly sales. The positive spending response was absent in counties with high shares of financially delinquent households, consistent with delinquent borrowers being liquidity constrained and unable to smooth consumption. Novel data on debt relief eligibility and applications suggest that student loan borrowers anticipated relief they ultimately did not receive and adjusted their spending in response.

**NBER Economics of Education Spring 2026, 10th Anniversary SAFE Household Finance Workshop*

**FMA 2025 Annual Meeting Best Paper Award (semifinalist)*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Who Benefits from Venture Capital? (with Victor Lyonnet and Léa Stern)

PUBLICATIONS

Pre-doctoral:

Institutional and Political Determinants of Statutory Tax Rates: Empirical Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa (with Sanjeev Gupta, Carlos Mulas-Granados, Jianhong Liu and Kelsey Ross)
Journal of African Development, 2021 [\[Article\]](#)

The Future of Central America: Challenges for Sustainable Development
Inter-American Development Bank, 2019 [\[Book\]](#)

INVITED CONFERENCES, SEMINARS, AND WORKSHOPS

2026: NBER SI Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence, NBER Economics of Transportation, NBER Economics of Education, SAFE Household Finance Workshop, American Economic Association, American Finance Association[†], Junior Academics Research Seminars in Finance, University of Texas at Dallas, Vanderbilt University

2025: Colorado Finance Summit, ABFR Doctoral Research Symposium, Coast-to-Coast Doctoral Workshop, Southern Finance Association^{*}, Financial Management Association, Society of Labor Economists, Wharton Innovation Doctoral Symposium, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar^{*}, NBER Entrepreneurship Research Boot Camp

2024: Western Economic Association International, Financial Management Association[†]

2023: Wharton Summer School on Structural Estimation in Corporate Finance, Finance Theory Group Summer School

^{} denotes presentations by co-authors, [†] denotes discussions, and [‡] denotes posters*

REFeree

Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Co-Organizer of the UW Finance PhD Alumni Conference 2026

Chair of the “Governance & Firm Management” session at FMA 2024

AWARDS

Edna Benson Fellowship 2023

Foster PhD Program Fellowship 2022

George and Pearl Corkery Scholarship 2019

Student Research Award 2016

Presidential Scholarship 2013–2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Washington

2019–2026

Teaching Assistant

- Corporate Finance (Undergraduate, Full-time MBA, Hybrid MBA)
- Advanced Corporate Finance (Full-time MBA)
- International Finance (Full-time MBA, Executive MBA)
- Game Theory (Full-time MBA)
- Introductory Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)
- Introductory Microeconomics (Undergraduate)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Washington

2021–2026

Research Associate

Center for Global Development

2017–2019

Research Assistant

Inter-American Development Bank

2017

Consultant

Boston University

2016

Research Assistant

United Nations Secretariat

2016

Intern

REFERENCES

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MISCELLANEOUS

Citizenship

United States

Data Clearance

Census Bureau Special Sworn Status

Languages

English, French, Urdu/Hindi, Spanish

Volunteer

Court Appointed Special Advocate (CASA)